CORPORATE POLICY REVIEW REPORT

A Review of the

CUSTOMER PROTECTION &
GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

of

ADANI ENTERPRISES LIMITED

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ACTIVITY TITLE: CORPORATE POLICY REVIEW REPORT

ORGANIZATION REVIEWED: ADANI ENTERPRISES LIMITED

POLICY NAME: CUSTOMER PROTECTION & GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

1. INTRODUCTION

Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) is the flagship company and business incubator of the Adani Group, one of India's largest diversified business conglomerates. AEL has grown from a trading company into an incubator of new businesses, and its current portfolio spans coal trading and mining, airports, roads, data centres, green hydrogen and agri-business. Several of these businesses — most visibly the Airports business — deal directly with retail consumers (a B2C segment), while others such as agri-trading and mining operate largely in a B2B environment. This mix of consumer-facing and business-facing operations makes customer protection and grievance redressal a genuinely cross-cutting governance concern for AEL.

Note on scope: Week 11 of this activity is titled "Banking Customer Protection Policy." Since Adani Enterprises Limited is not a banking company and does not maintain a banking-specific customer protection policy, this report instead reviews AEL's applicable equivalent — its Customer Protection & Grievance Redressal mechanism, as disclosed in its Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report (BRSR) under Principle 9 ("Businesses should engage with and provide value to their consumers in a responsible manner") and its broader Stakeholder Grievance Redressal framework. This keeps the review grounded in a real, verifiable AEL policy rather than an inapplicable banking framework, while still addressing the same underlying theme of customer rights, grievance redressal, transparency and protection mechanisms.

The purpose of this review is to study AEL's Customer Protection & Grievance Redressal framework as a case study in stakeholder governance — to understand how the company receives, processes and resolves consumer complaints, how this aligns with regulatory expectations, and where it could be strengthened. This is a structured, student-level analysis rather than a legal audit.

2. POLICY OVERVIEW

2.1 Name and Nature of the Policy

AEL's customer protection framework is not issued as a single standalone "customer protection policy" document but is instead disclosed and structured through its annual BRSR

filing (Principle 9 — consumer engagement) together with its company-level Stakeholder Grievance Redressal mechanism. In substance, it functions as an operational policy: it defines complaint channels, response timelines, escalation levels and monitoring practices for customer grievances across AEL's businesses.

2.2 Scope of the Policy

The mechanism applies across both AEL's B2B and B2C business segments. It is most developed in the Airports business, which is AEL's principal consumer-facing (B2C) operation, but the broader stakeholder grievance framework is designed to also capture complaints from value-chain partners, communities, investors, shareholders and employees, positioning "customers" as one of several formally recognised stakeholder groups whose grievances the company tracks and reports on.

2.3 Customers and Stakeholders Covered

Directly covered are the customers and end-users of AEL's consumer-facing businesses — most notably airport passengers and users of airport services. Indirectly, the same grievance infrastructure (multi-channel complaint intake, escalation matrices, service-level timelines) extends to business customers and value-chain partners engaging with AEL's B2B operations such as agri-trading, mining and resources.

2.4 Key Objectives of the Policy

- To provide customers with multiple, accessible channels to raise complaints and feedback — including email, web portals, mobile applications, helplines and WhatsApp.
- To ensure complaints are acknowledged and resolved within clearly defined service-level timelines.
- To build a structured escalation matrix so unresolved complaints move to higher levels of review rather than being left unaddressed.
- To use data-driven analytics to monitor grievance patterns, identify recurring process-level issues, and improve service quality over time.

- To transparently disclose complaint volumes and resolution status annually through the BRSR framework, in line with the National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct.

3. KEY PROVISIONS OF THE POLICY (FOCUS: CUSTOMER RIGHTS, GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL, TRANSPARENCY, PROTECTION MECHANISMS)

3.1 Multi-Channel Complaint Access

AEL provides customers with a range of channels to lodge complaints, including email, web portals, mobile applications, dedicated helplines and WhatsApp, with AI-enabled chatbots and automated service tools deployed in select businesses. This reflects a customer right to be heard through a channel of their convenience, rather than being restricted to a single, potentially inconvenient point of contact.

3.2 Acknowledgment and Resolution Timelines

In the Airports business specifically, customer complaints and feedback are acknowledged within 24 hours of submission, and a standardised process ensures resolution within a defined timeframe. This time-bound commitment is a concrete procedural right — it gives customers a reasonable expectation of when their complaint will be looked at and resolved, rather than leaving resolution open-ended.

3.3 Escalation Matrix

The grievance mechanism is guided by clearly defined escalation matrices, meaning complaints that are not resolved satisfactorily at the first point of contact can be escalated to higher levels within the organisation. This gives customers and other stakeholders a structured route to pursue unresolved issues rather than having their complaint close informally without adequate resolution.

3.4 Data-Driven Monitoring and Continuous Improvement

AEL states that it leverages data-driven analytics to monitor customer feedback, identify recurring issues, and address process-level gaps, with continuous tracking of grievance redressal performance. This turns grievance handling from a purely reactive function into an

input for service improvement — recurring complaint themes are expected to feed back into operational changes.

3.5 Transparency and Disclosure

AEL discloses, on an annual basis through its BRSR filing, whether a grievance redressal mechanism is in place for each stakeholder group (including customers), along with the number of complaints filed and the number pending resolution at year-end. For example, AEL's FY 2024-25 BRSR disclosure reported 6,339 customer complaints filed during the year with nil pending at year-close, compared with 3,063 complaints filed in FY 2023-24, also fully resolved. This year-on-year, publicly disclosed complaint data is a meaningful transparency and accountability mechanism, allowing external stakeholders to track both complaint volume trends and resolution performance.

3.6 Responsibilities of the Company and of Customers

The company's responsibility under this framework is to acknowledge complaints promptly, resolve them within defined timelines, escalate unresolved matters appropriately, and report outcomes transparently. Customers, in turn, are expected to raise complaints through the designated channels and provide accurate information to enable timely investigation and resolution — a cooperative relationship that mirrors how most structured consumer-grievance systems are designed to work.

4. COMPLIANCE AND GOVERNANCE ANALYSIS

AEL's consumer engagement and grievance redressal disclosures are structured directly around Principle 9 of the National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct (NGRBC), issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, which requires businesses to engage with and provide value to their consumers in a responsible manner. Reporting complaint numbers, resolution status and mechanism availability by stakeholder group is a mandatory component of the Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report (BRSR) format prescribed by SEBI for the top listed companies by market capitalisation, of which AEL is one.

Because AEL's Airports business serves the public directly, its complaint-handling practices also operate in the shadow of general consumer-protection law in India — principally the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, which establishes consumer rights (to safety, information,

choice, redressal) and consumer dispute redressal commissions as an external escalation route beyond a company's own internal mechanism. Airport-specific service standards are additionally shaped by regulatory oversight from bodies such as the Airports Economic Regulatory Authority (AERA) and the Ministry of Civil Aviation, which set expectations around passenger facilitation and service quality at Indian airports.

From a governance standpoint, embedding grievance-redressal disclosure within the annual BRSR — reviewed and reported alongside financial and ESG performance — ties customer-facing accountability directly to board-level oversight and statutory disclosure obligations under SEBI's Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR) Regulations, 2015. This gives customer grievance performance a visibility at the governance level that a purely operational, unreported customer-service process would lack.

5. POLICY EVALUATION

5.1 Strengths

- Multiple, modern complaint channels (web, app, helpline, WhatsApp, chatbots) that meet customers where they already are, rather than relying on a single legacy channel.
- A concrete, time-bound commitment in the Airports business (24-hour acknowledgment plus a defined resolution window) that gives customers a measurable service expectation.
- A defined escalation matrix, so unresolved complaints have a formal route upward rather than being closed by default.
- Annual public disclosure of complaint volumes and resolution status through the BRSR, which is a genuine transparency strength compared with companies that do not disclose such data at all.
- Use of data analytics to convert grievance patterns into process improvements, rather than treating each complaint in isolation.

5.2 Effectiveness and Practicality of Implementation

The reported outcomes are, on the surface, very strong: AEL's BRSR disclosures show all customer complaints in both FY 2023-24 and FY 2024-25 as fully resolved by year-end, with none pending. This suggests the mechanism is functioning at an operational level, at least as far as closing complaints within the reporting year is concerned. However, "nil pending at year-close" measures closure, not necessarily the quality or customer satisfaction of the resolution — a complaint can be formally closed without the customer being fully satisfied. The near-doubling of customer complaints from 3,063 in FY 2023-24 to 6,339 in FY 2024-25 is also worth examining: it could reflect either a genuine rise in service issues (for example, from an expanding, higher-traffic airports business) or simply greater ease of lodging complaints through the newer digital channels — the disclosure as it stands does not distinguish between the two.

5.3 Gaps, Limitations and Areas Requiring Improvement

- The BRSR disclosure gives aggregate complaint counts but does not break these down by business segment (Airports vs agri vs mining) or by complaint category (service quality, billing, delay, safety), which limits how useful the published data is for tracking specific problem areas.

- No specific resolution timeline (in days) is disclosed outside the Airports business, so it is unclear whether the same 24-hour-acknowledgment standard applies consistently across AEL's other consumer-facing touchpoints.

- There is no publicly disclosed customer satisfaction score or repeat-complaint rate, which would give a fuller picture of grievance-handling quality beyond simple closure counts.

- The escalation matrix and its various levels are referenced but not published in public disclosures with named contact points or maximum escalation timelines, unlike some peer companies' consumer grievance policies.

5.4 Comparison with Good Corporate Practice

Compared with sector-specific grievance frameworks — for instance, the banking-sector Banking Ombudsman Scheme or RBI-mandated bank grievance redressal policies, which publish named Grievance Redressal Officers, defined multi-level escalation timelines (often 7, 15 and 30 working days per level), and an external ombudsman as a final escalation route

— AEL's disclosed mechanism is comparatively general. It performs well on channel accessibility and annual transparency but would benefit from adopting the same level of procedural specificity (named escalation contacts, tiered timelines, and an independent external escalation route) that regulated sectors such as banking and insurance are required to maintain.

6. BUSINESS RELEVANCE

For a company with a growing consumer-facing footprint — particularly through its Airports business, which handles large volumes of passengers daily — an effective customer protection and grievance redressal mechanism is directly tied to brand reputation, regulatory standing and repeat business. Airports are high-visibility, high-frequency service environments where a poor complaint experience can quickly become public and reputationally damaging, making structured, time-bound grievance handling a genuine commercial necessity rather than a compliance afterthought.

For customers, a multi-channel, time-bound grievance mechanism translates into a tangible right to be heard and to receive a timely response, which builds trust in AEL's consumer-facing businesses. For business (B2B) customers and value-chain partners in AEL's agri-trading and resources businesses, a functioning escalation mechanism supports smoother commercial relationships and reduces the risk of unresolved disputes damaging long-term partnerships. For the company itself, transparent annual disclosure of complaint data through the BRSR supports investor and regulator confidence by demonstrating that consumer-facing risk is being actively tracked and managed at the governance level.

More broadly, this framework contributes to AEL's risk-management architecture: a responsive grievance mechanism reduces the risk of complaints escalating into regulatory action, consumer-forum litigation, or reputational harm, while the analytics-driven feedback loop supports continuous improvement in service delivery — a meaningful contribution to both ethical business conduct and long-term customer trust.

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Publish a segment-wise and category-wise breakdown of customer complaints (by business and by complaint type) in future BRSR disclosures, rather than a single aggregate figure, to make the data more actionable for both management and external stakeholders.

- Extend the Airports business's 24-hour acknowledgment and defined resolution-timeline standard explicitly to all other consumer-facing touchpoints, and disclose the specific timelines publicly.

- Introduce and publish a named Grievance Redressal Officer or equivalent escalation contact for customer complaints, along with defined timelines at each escalation level, similar to practices in regulated sectors such as banking and insurance.

- Disclose a customer satisfaction or repeat-complaint metric alongside the raw complaint-count and resolution-status figures, to give a fuller picture of grievance-handling quality.

- Investigate and explain, in future disclosures, the significant year-on-year increase in customer complaints, distinguishing genuine service issues from increased ease of complaint-lodging through digital channels.

- Consider providing customers an external escalation route (such as an independent ombudsman-style review) for complaints that remain unresolved after internal escalation, strengthening the credibility of the mechanism.

8. CONCLUSION

AEL's Customer Protection & Grievance Redressal framework — disclosed through its BRSR Principle 9 reporting and its Airports business's operational practices — reflects a reasonably mature, multi-channel approach to receiving and resolving customer complaints, backed by defined acknowledgment timelines, an escalation matrix, and data-driven monitoring. The company's disclosed track record of fully resolving reported customer

complaints in both FY 2023-24 and FY 2024-25 is a positive indicator, though the underlying data would benefit from greater segmentation and more granular public disclosure.

At the same time, the framework would be strengthened by more procedural specificity — named escalation contacts, tiered resolution timelines, satisfaction metrics, and an independent external escalation route — bringing it closer to the standards seen in more heavily regulated, consumer-facing sectors such as banking. This review highlights a broader lesson relevant to any business student: as a diversified conglomerate's consumer-facing footprint grows, grievance redressal moves from being a simple customer-service function to a genuine governance and risk-management priority, and its real value depends on how transparently and specifically that mechanism is disclosed, monitored and continuously improved.

9. REFERENCES

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